



TALK ABOUT REMARKABLE PEOPLE

FIVE SHORT LIVES · THE PHRASES YOU NEED TO DESCRIBE THEM

READ THE FIVE LIVES

The phrases in bold are the ones you have to learn.

1 ELIZABETH I · 1533–1603

Elizabeth I **was born in 1533** and **came from a royal family**; her father was King Henry VIII. She **received a very good education** at Hatfield Palace, and by the age of thirteen she spoke several languages. She became queen in 1558 and never married, because she wanted to keep the power herself. Many people say that this **influential leader changed the course of English history**. She **died at the age of 69**.

2 HORATIO NELSON · 1758–1805

Horatio Nelson **was born in 1758** and **grew up in a small village** in England. He joined the navy when he was twelve and **took part in many important battles** at sea. He lost the sight in one eye, and then he lost his right arm, but he went back to his ship. At Trafalgar in 1805 he **made history**: the British won, but Nelson **died at the age of 47**. For many people he is still **an inspiring leader**.

3 JOHN LENNON · 1940–1980

John Lennon **was born in 1940** in Liverpool, and his aunt Mimi brought him up. In 1956 he formed his first band, and later that band became the Beatles. The group **achieved great success** all over the world, and in 1965 they **won an award**: the Queen made all four of them Members of the Order of the British Empire. Lennon also **played an important role in the peace movement**, and he **is remembered for his songs**. He **died at the age of 40**.

4 PRINCESS DIANA · 1961–1997

Diana Spencer **was born in 1961** and **came from an old, rich family** – her father was an earl. She **did not study at university**. In 1981 she married Prince Charles and became **a prominent figure** all over the world. She visited hospitals, helped people with HIV/AIDS and worked to stop landmines, so she **had a strong influence on society**. She **died at the age of 36**, and people **remember her for her charity work**.

5 ISAAC NEWTON · 1642–1727

Isaac Newton **was born in 1642** on a farm in England. He **studied at university** in Cambridge, and there he **made an important contribution to science**. He **made a discovery** about light: white light is a mixture of all the colours. Today he is **best known for his discovery** of gravity, and every school book calls him **an outstanding scientist**. He **died at the age of 84**.

WORDS TO KNOW

a figure – an important person that many people know about**influential** – able to change what other people think or do**a contribution** – something useful that you add to a piece of work**a movement** – a group of people who work together for one idea**outstanding** – much better than the others**to achieve** – to get something after working for it**an award** – a prize or an honour that somebody gives you**society** – all the people of a country, taken together



1 FIND THE PHRASE

Which paragraph is it in? Write 1–5.

1. to grow up in a small village
2. to come from an old, rich family
3. to receive a very good education
4. to study at university in Cambridge
5. to achieve great success
6. to win an award
7. to take part in many important battles
8. to make an important contribution to science
9. to have a strong influence on society
10. to change the course of English history

2 WHO IS IT?

E = Elizabeth I · N = Nelson · L = Lennon · D = Diana · I = Isaac Newton

1. This person was an influential leader who never married.
why?
2. This person was an inspiring leader at sea.
why?
3. This person was a talented musician who formed a band in 1956.
why?
4. This person was an outstanding scientist.
why?
5. This person was a prominent figure and did a lot of charity work.
why?
6. This person was a historical figure who died at the age of 47.
why?
7. This person is best known for a discovery about gravity.
why?
8. This person played an important role in the peace movement.
why?

E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I
E	N	L	D	I



3 BUILD THE PHRASE

Write a, b, c, d, e, f, g or h.

- | | |
|--|---------------|
| 1. <input type="text"/> an influential ... | a. person |
| 2. <input type="text"/> an outstanding ... | b. musician |
| 3. <input type="text"/> a prominent ... | c. politician |
| 4. <input type="text"/> a talented ... | d. writer |
| 5. <input type="text"/> a well-known ... | e. figure |
| 6. <input type="text"/> a successful ... | f. leader |
| 7. <input type="text"/> a respected ... | g. scientist |
| 8. <input type="text"/> a remarkable ... | h. explorer |

4 THE MISSING VERB

Use the words in the box. Each word once.

ACHIEVED DIED HAD MADE PLAYED RECEIVED TOOK WON

- Nelson grew up in a small village and _____ part in many important battles.
- Elizabeth _____ a very good education at Hatfield Palace.
- The Beatles _____ great success all over the world.
- In 1965 the group _____ an award from the Queen.
- Newton _____ an important contribution to science.
- Diana _____ a strong influence on society.
- Lennon _____ an important role in the peace movement.
- Nelson _____ at the age of 47.

5 FACT OR OPINION?

Circle one. An opinion needs a reason.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Newton died at the age of 84. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |
| 2. Newton was an outstanding scientist. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |
| 3. Elizabeth was queen for 44 years. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |
| 4. Elizabeth changed the course of English history. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |
| 5. Nelson lost his right arm. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |
| 6. Nelson was an inspiring leader. | <input type="text"/> FACT <input type="text"/> OPINION |



6 NOW YOUR PERSON

Six sentences. Every opinion pays with a fact.

Write six sentences about **your** person. Use a different phrase from tasks 3 and 4 in each one. After every opinion write *because* and one fact.

1. *He / She was a prominent figure in ...*

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.....

2. *He / She was born in ... and grew up ...*

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.....

3. *He / She became famous for ...*

.....
.....

4. *He / She made an important contribution to ...*

.....
.....

5. *One of his / her greatest achievements was ...*

.....
.....

6. *He / She is remembered for ...*

.....
.....

BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN

Read your six sentences again and find every word that somebody could argue with – *great, influential, remarkable, inspiring*. Each of them needs a date, a number or an event standing right behind it. If it has none, cross the word out or find the fact.